Parking lot USB exercise

You are part of the security team at Rhetorical Hospital and arrive to work one morning. On the ground of the parking lot, you find a USB stick with the hospital's logo printed on it. There's no one else around who might have dropped it, so you decide to pick it up out of curiosity.

You bring the USB drive back to your office where the team has virtualization software installed on a workstation. Virtualization software can be used for this very purpose because it's one of the only ways to safely investigate an unfamiliar USB stick. The software works by running a simulated instance of the computer on the same workstation. This simulation isn't connected to other files or networks, so the USB drive can't affect other systems if it happens to be infected with malicious software.

Contents	Write **2-3 sentences** about the types of information found on this device. ● *There are files containing PII, like the wedding (wife to be name and guestlist), travel info, and even a hire letter* ● *There is employee budget info and shift schedule* ● *Its not safe to mix personal info with work info*
Attacker mindset	● *Against other employees: Using shift schedules to identify who is alone at the hospital and deceive them.* ● *Against family members: Using photos of dogs or weddings to send fake emails that appear legitimate.* ● *Access to the business: Jorge's resume reveals which software and systems he is familiar with, giving the hacker a map of weaknesses to look for in the hospital's servers.*

Risk analysis	• Write 3 or 4 sentences describing technical, operational, or managerial controls that could mitigate these types of attacks: • What types of malicious software could be hidden on these devices? What could have happened if the device were infected and discovered by another employee? It could have a fake USB drive disguised as a keyboard, which could contain malware or a virus to gain access. The USB drive itself might not belong to Jorge and could be a social engineering attack designed to trick someone into opening the USB drive on a company computer. • What sensitive information could a threat actor find on a device like this? Private personal information to trick Jorge or his family into clicking on a link or sending an important document, information about other employees, schedules, salaries, etc. • How might that information be used against an individual or an organization? It could contain malware itself, or the information could be used to gain legitimacy by carrying out social engineering attacks.

Jorge's drive contains a mix of personal and work-related files. For example, it contains folders that appear to store family and pet photos. There is also a new hire letter and an employee shift schedule.

Review the types of information that Jorge has stored on this device. Then, in the **Contents** row of the activity template, write **2-3 sentences** (40-60 words) about the type of information that's stored on the USB drive.

Note: *USB drives often contain an assortment of personally identifiable information (PII). Attackers can easily use this sensitive information to target the data owner or others around them.*

Step 3: Apply an attacker mindset to the contents of the USB drive

The flash drive appears to contain a mixture of personal and work-related files. Consider how an attacker might use this information if they obtained it. Also, consider whether this whole event was staged.

For example, an attacker could have placed these files on the USB drive as a distraction. They might have targeted Jorge or someone he knows, hoping they would find the device and plug it into their workstation. In doing so, the attacker could establish a

backdoor into the company's systems while the unsuspecting target browsed through the files.

In the **Attacker mindset** row of the activity template, write **2-3 sentences** (40-60 words) about how this information could be used against Jorge or the hospital.

Pro tip: *The Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) provides some security tips on using caution with USB drives, including keeping personal and business drives separate.*

Step 4: Analyze the risks of finding a parking lot USB

You have *not* opened any of the files on the device, which is best practice.

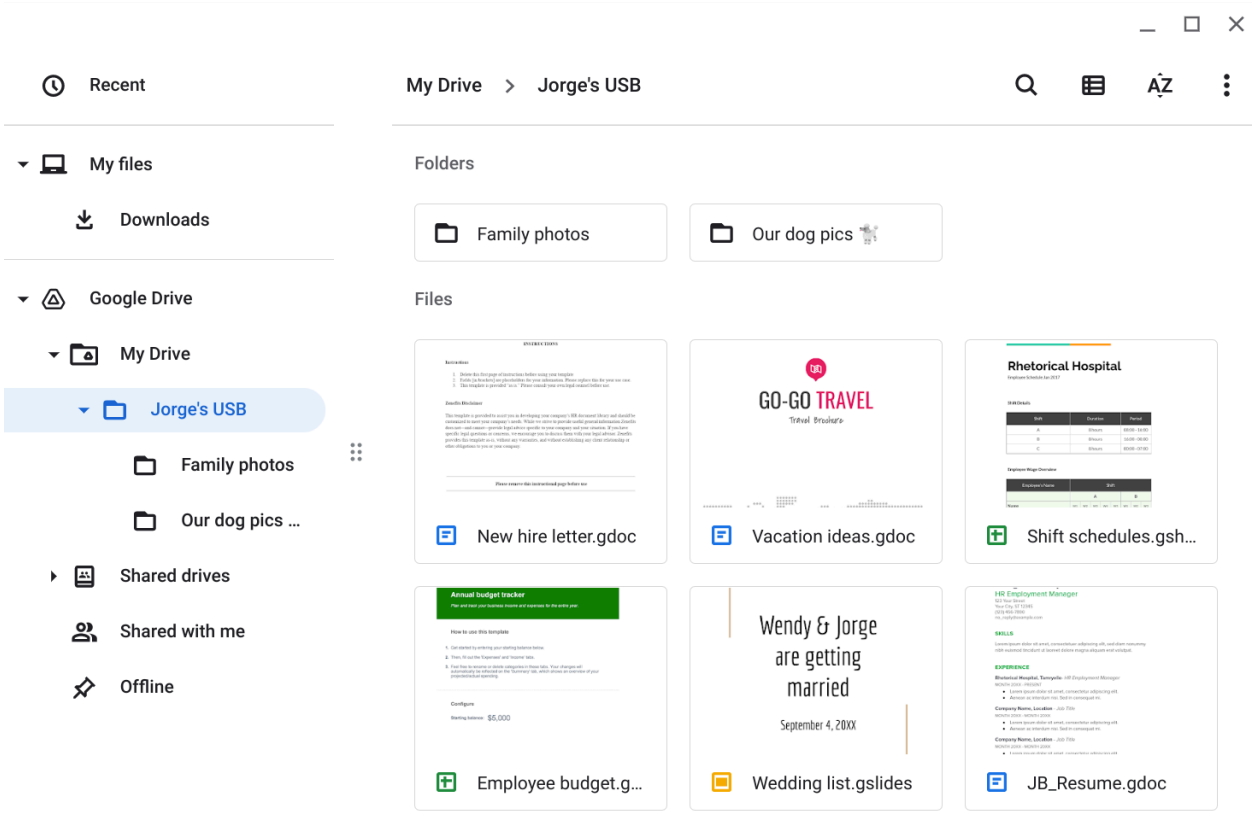
Attackers sometimes conduct USB baiting attacks to deliver malicious code that they've crafted.

However, this USB drive was still a security risk even though it did not contain malicious code. It could have easily been found by an attacker who might have used its contents to plan a variety of attacks.

Consider some of the risks associated with USB baiting attacks:

- What types of malicious software could be hidden on these devices? What could have happened if the device were infected and discovered by another employee?
- What sensitive information could a threat actor find on a device like this?
- How might that information be used against an individual or an organization?

In the **Risk analysis** row of the activity template, write **3 or 4 sentences** (60-80 words) describing any technical, operational, or managerial controls that could mitigate USB baiting attacks.


Recent
My Drive > Jorge's USB
My files
Downloads
Google Drive
My Drive
Jorge's USB
Family photos
Our dog pics ...
Shared drives
Shared with me
Offline
Folders
Family photos
Our dog pics
Files
New hire letter.gdoc
GO-GO TRAVEL
Travel Brochure
Vacation ideas.gdoc
Rhetorical Hospital
Shift schedules.gsh...
Annual budget tracker
Employee budget.g...
Wendy & Jorge are getting married
September 4, 20XX
Wedding list.gslides
HR Employment Manager
JB_Resume.gdoc